



Imagination Exercises

We want the client's imagination engaged before the session because the imagination can be considered "the language" of the Higher Self. Some people rarely flex "the muscle" of their imaginations at all or think they cannot, or have been so programmed to distrust their imagination that we want them to at least begin to address those issues before the session, so imagination becomes more accessible.

Some clients will benefit from a brief "exercise" and I typically do this just before creating the intention statement before the session. This need not take long and not every client needs this kind of preparation and assurance. You will discover their likely need when you ask about their experience with hypnosis, guided imagery and daydreaming.

Visualization is only one facet of human-accessible senses that can be accessed to ignite and encourage use of the imagination. Each of our senses can provide information to create new or different realities for us to experience. We do tend to focus on visualization because it matches the way we talk, "Don't you see that you are creating your own reality?" "Can you see what I mean?" But, some people get "hung up" on the idea that they cannot visualize and I have found that even if they cannot at all allow for imagery, it makes no difference at all in the outcome of a session.

Some people get their information by hearing words, songs, advice or tones. Some get information by sense of touch, textures and shapes... or kinesthetic information- like movements or dancing. One can actually get information by smell and taste, as well, but these senses are more rarely used. Others just "know" the answers and others still FEEL the answers either with emotions or their physical bodies.

The idea of accessing imagination rather than dismissing it while actually appreciating and encouraging it can create real change in our lives. We are powerful, creative beings and our body and our minds can respond to our desire for change. If your client balks at any of these exercises just tell them it's just easy and fun, to play along and "make it up" and not think too hard, do not try to provide "correct" answers just answer without analyzing and then tell them this is how it works in a session as well.

Lemon Exercise

This is a classic example of how our bodies respond to our imagination "as if" it was a physical reality.

Imagine walking in to your kitchen, opening up your refrigerator and finding a bowl of large, fresh lemons. Take the bowl out and set it on the counter. Choose a lemon and feel its cold and bumpy texture. Roll it between your hands. Set the lemon down on a wooden cutting board and find a sharp knife and cut the



lemon into two pieces. Feel the liquid on your fingers and smell the fresh lemon juice scent fill your nostrils. Now, pick up one of the lemon halves and bite down into it with your teeth. Allow a big mouthful of cold juice over your tongue and swirl it around your mouth before swallowing. Very few people do not have a physical reaction to the lemon exercise!

Visualizations

Most people can describe their front door, their homes or their cars. How else do you find your way home, know which house is yours in the neighborhood or find your vehicle in a parking lot?

Front Door and Closet Exercise

You can lead your client into a simple exercise asking them to stand outside of their front door. Have them describe the door. What material is it made from? What color is the door? What kind of handle is it? Have them walk in. What are the first things they see? What kind of flooring, what furniture is nearby? Have them walk to the nearest closet. Have them open the door as there will be a “surprise” inside for them to find. Then ask them what surprise they find. The answer is often useful information for the client.

Red Bird and Hat Exercise

Here is another fun game you can play with your client. First, ask them to see or imagine or remember a red bird (or pick another color if you don’t have red birds where you live). Wait until they say okay, then ask them what kind of bird it was. They may say it was a cardinal, a robin or a cartoon bird or something else completely. Whatever they say is fine. Then ask them to put a hat on that bird. When they say okay, ask them, what kind of hat was it? When they tell you what kind of hat, ask them the color of the hat. When you are done with this ask them if they actually visualized the bird and hat or just imagined them or just “knew” what details in which to respond. Then tell them this is the way information can come to them in a session.



Farm Animal Exercise

I use this one a lot as I live on a farm. I tell them that we are going to pretend that I brought an animal from my farm to the studio to visit them. I tell them it's outside and I am going to pretend to go get it and bring it in to meet them. I tell them it may be an animal they expect to live on a farm, not expect to live on a farm in Kansas, or an animal they have never even imagined existed before. I tell them I am now walking through the door with the animal and ask them, "What is it?" Their answers are very enlightening and are often, but not always, descriptive of the client themselves.

Delivery Man Exercise

Ask your client to imagine someone knocking at the door and then finding a delivery man with a package for them. Have them describe first the man; color of hair, eyes, skin, clothing, etc. Next have them describe the package, size, weight, shape, etc. Then have them open the package and ask what is inside.